

UPSC Prelims

Environment & Ecology

Class No. 4

Indian Laws

Wildlife Protection Act, 1972



- **Background of the Act**
- The legislation is based on a Resolution of the Legislature of 11 States, invoking Article 252 of the Constitution that provides for Parliament to pass a common law for two or more States making such a request by a resolution of the State Legislature.
- The Act initially applied to only those State Governments whose Legislatures passed the requisite resolution, but was later extended to all States through the Wild Life (Protection) Amendment Act 1991 after the subject “protection of wild animals and birds (17B)” was brought to Concurrent List.

Wildlife Protection Act, 1972



- **The act provides for:**
- State wildlife advisory boards
- Defines wildlife related terminologies like habitat, hunting, zoo, sanctuary, National Park, Reserve forest etc.
- Regulations for hunting wild animals and birds
- Establishment of sanctuaries and national parks — State Government by Notification (no need to pass any law) declare an area as a Sanctuary/National Park
- Central government can declare an area as a Sanctuary or NP where the state government ceases, or otherwise transfer any area within a sanctuary, to central government.

Wildlife Protection Act, 1972



- Regulations for trade in wild animals, animal products and trophies
- Management of Zoos
- Judicially imposed penalties for violating the Act.
- According to the act, the State government may appoint Chief Wildlife Warden. Central government may appoint directors and assistant directors.
- Is against taxidermy (preservation of dead wild animals as trophy or in the form of skins, antlers, horns, eggs, teeth or nails).

Wildlife Protection Act, 1972



- Authorities established under this act:
- Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (statutory status)– headed by Director of Wildlife Preservation – appointed by Central Government
- Chief Wildlife Warden – state Governments
- Central Zoo Authority
- National Board of Wildlife – headed by Prime Minister
- State Board of Wildlife – headed by Chief Minister
- National Tiger Conservation Authority – headed by minister of Ministry of Environment Forest and Climate Change
- Tiger conservation foundation – To be established by states

Wildlife Protection Act, 1972



- The act has been amended **8 times** so far 1982, 1986, 1991, 1993, 2002, 2006, 2013 and 2022
- **1982 amendment:**
- Introduced a provision permitting the capture and transportation of wild animals for the scientific management of animal population.
- **2002 amendment:**
- It made punishment and penalty more stringent.
- Provision for National Board for Wildlife. : no alteration in boundaries of NP/ WLS without it.

Wildlife Protection Act, 1972



- **2006 amendment:**
 - National Tiger Conservation Authority
 - Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB)
- **2013 amendment:**
 - Provision of imprisonment up to 7 years.
 - Protects hunting rights of Scheduled Tribes in Andaman and Nicobar Island.

Wildlife Protection Act, 1972



- **Delineation of Powers:**
- No human activity is permitted inside a NP except for ones permitted by Chief Wildlife Warden of State.
- Chief Wild Life Warden may permit hunting of any wild animal if it has become dangerous to human life or is so disabled or diseased as to be beyond recovery.
- Both State and Central Governments can notify National Parks and Wildlife Sanctuaries under the act.

Wildlife Protection Act, 1972



- Alteration of boundaries can be done by States only with prior approval of National Board for Wildlife (NBWL).
- Central government may, by notification, declare any wild animal specified in Schedule II to be Vermin (wild animals that are harmful to crops, animals, or which carry disease, e.g., rodents) **[2022 Amendment]**
- Eg- The Centre's declaration of nilgais as vermin in Bihar and monkeys as vermin in Shimla and refusal to declare wild boars as vermin in Kerala have become controversial and invited criticism
- Central Government may add or delete any entry to or from any Schedule or transfer any entry from one Part of a Schedule to another Part of the same Schedule or from one Schedule to another.

Wildlife Protection (Amendment) Act, 2022



- Implement provisions of Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES). This is a convention to prevent illegal trade in wildlife. It has 3 appendices with varying levels of protection.
- Central government to designate a:
 - (i) Management Authority, which grants export or import permits for trade of specimens
 - (ii) Scientific Authority, which gives advice on aspects related to impact on the survival of the specimens being traded.

Wildlife Protection (Amendment) Act, 2022



- Every person engaging in trade of a scheduled specimen must report the details of the transaction to the Management Authority.
- Identification mark to be used by the Management Authority for a specimen, as per CITES.
- Forbidden to change the identification mark.

Wildlife Protection (Amendment) Act, 2022



- Rationalization of schedules

Schedule	Earlier	Now
Schedule I	Animal Species with highest level of protection	Animal Species with highest level of protection
Schedule II	Higher protection than Schedule III and IV but lower than Schedule I	Animal Species with lower level of protection
Schedule III	Protected species with hunting prohibited but the penalty for any violation is less compared to the first two schedules.	Protected Plant species
Schedule IV		Specimen listed under CITES Appendices
Schedule V	Vermin	-
Schedule VI	Protected Plant species	-

Wildlife Protection (Amendment) Act, 2022



- Wild animals will be declared as Vermin by Central Government by the way of notification for any area and for a specified period.
- Increase in penalties

Violation	1972 Act	2022 Amendment
General Violation	Up to Rs 25,000	Up to Rs 1,00,000
Specially protected animals	At least Rs 10,000	At least Rs 25,000

Wildlife Protection (Amendment) Act, 2022



- Chief Wildlife Warden will manage and protect sanctuaries in accordance with the management plans prepared as per guidelines of the **central government**. Earlier such provision was not there : federalism issues.
- In case of sanctuaries falling under scheduled areas (which schedule, think?) or areas where FRA 2006 is applicable, the management plan for such sanctuary will be prepared after due consultation with the gram sabha concerned. {Important : gram sabha has a key role in FRA}

Wildlife Protection (Amendment) Act, 2022



- Exemptions for live elephants
- Transfer or transport of live elephants allowed for a religious or any other purpose by person having ownership certificates in accordance with conditions prescribed by the Central Government.
- Central government empowered to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of **invasive alien species**.
- It empowers the Central government to declare areas adjacent to National Parks and Wild Life Sanctuaries as Conservation Reserves for protecting flora and fauna, and their habitat.
- Earlier- only state government had such powers
- Community Reserves are declared by States

Using lateral knowledge



- "While the national political parties in India favour centralisation, the regional parties are in favour of State autonomy." Comment.
- Question in Mains 2022.

Wildlife Protection (Amendment) Act, 2022



- It provides for any person to voluntarily surrender any captive animals or animal products to the Chief Wild Life Warden : to avoid abandonment.
- No compensation will be paid to the person for surrendering and surrendered items will become the state's property.
- State board of wildlife permitted to constitute a standing committee.
- No renewal of any arms licenses to be granted to any person residing within 10km of a sanctuary except under the intimation of the Chief WL Warden.

Indian Forest Act, 1927



- The Indian Forest Act (IFA), 1927 was largely based on previous Indian Forest Acts implemented under the British.
- The most famous one was the Indian Forest Act of 1878.
- Provides legal framework for protection and management of forest and duty leviable on Timber.
- It provides for procedure to be followed for declaring an area to be Reserve or Protected or Village Forest
- **2017 Amendment**
- Amended the definition of tree to remove the word bamboos.
- It means, bamboo growing in non-forest areas will be waived off the requirement of permission for its felling or transportation for economic use.

Indian Forest Act, 1927



- **Reserve Forest**
- State government may constitute any forest land or waste land as reserved forest which is the property of Government and may sell the produce from these forests.
- Before issuing official notification state government needs to appoint a Forest Settlement Officer (has power of Civil Courts) to inquire and to provide settlements to persons belonging to that area.
- All activities are **prohibited unless permitted** in RFs.

Indian Forest Act, 1927



- **Protected Forest**
- State government may constitute any forest land or waste land not included in Reserve Forest as Protected Forest.
- Protected forests are of 2 kinds:
 1. Demarcated protected forests
 2. Undemarcated protected forests
- All activities are **permitted unless prohibited** in PFs.

Indian Forest Act, 1927



- **Village Forest**
- State government can assign to any village community the rights of government (to or over) any land which has been constituted as reserved forest.
- It may make rules for regulating the management of village forest, prescribing conditions under which the community may be provided with timber or other forest produce or pasture
- Degree of protection: Reserved forests > Protected forests > Village forests

Forest Conservation Act, 1980



- **Background of the Act**
- The Forest (Conservation) Act 1980, flows from entry 17A of List III (Concurrent List) of the Seventh Schedule.
- This was facilitated by the Constitution (42nd Amendment) Act 1976, which inter alia moved the subject from the State List to the Concurrent List.
- It was enacted in response to the rapid decline in the forest covers in India, and also to fulfil the Constitutional obligation under Article 48-A

Forest Conservation Act, 1980



- Enacted to consolidate the law related to forest, to control unchecked deforestation, the transit of forest produces and the duty leviable on timber and other forest produce.
- Forest officers and their staff administer the Forest Act.
- Under the provisions of this Act, prior approval of the Central Government is required for diversion of forestlands for non-forest purposes.
- An Advisory Committee constituted under the Act advises the Central Government on these approvals.
- Rule making powers- Central Government

Forest Conservation Act, 1980



- The Act deals with the four categories of the forests, namely reserved forests, village forests, protected forests and private forests.
- 1992 Amendment: It provisioned for allowing some non-forest activities in forests, without cutting trees or limited cutting with prior approval of the Central Govt.
- **TN Godavarman Thirumulkpad vs the Union of India) judgement:**
- Supreme Court noted that the Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980, was brought in to prevent deforestation and goes on to add that its nature of land classification doesn't matter.

Forest Conservation Act, 1980



- The order read that “the provisions made for the conservation of forests must apply to all forests irrespective of the nature of ownership or classification thereof.”
- The court had also said that forests will not just be areas recorded as forest land in government records, but all areas which are similar to the dictionary definition of a forest.
- Under the Godavarman order, the states are supposed to identify and notify forests.
- The Forest Advisory Committee, the apex body that deliberates on granting permission to fell forests said, “criteria finalised by a state need not be subject to approval by Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Forest Conservation Act, 1980



- **Forest Conservation Rules, 2022:**
- Formation of Committees-
- It constitutes an Advisory Committee, a regional empowered committee at each of the integrated regional offices and a screening committee at State/Union Territory (UT) government-level.
- These rules will replace the forest conservation rules of 2003.
- Provides a certain time frame for projects to be cleared.
- Approval procedure : In principle approval after considering the recommendations of advisory committee, then final approval from central government.

Forest Conservation Act, 1980



Committees	Features
Project screening committee	• To be constituted by State or UT. • To meet atleast twice every month to recommend projects to State/UTs administration. • To examine the proposal received from the State Government or Union territory Administration, except proposals involving forest land of five hectares or less.
Regional Empowered Committee	• To be setup by Central govt in each of the regional offices. • To meet atleast twice every month to examine every referred project for approval or rejection.
Advisory Committee	• To be setup by the Central govt consisting 6 members to meet every month. • To advise with regards to grant of approval under various sections of rules.

Forest Conservation Act, 1980



Zoos exempted from permissions under FCA :

MoEFCC has approved consideration of Central Zoo Authority of considering Zoos on forest land as forestry activity.

Earlier, zoos, rescue centers etc. was considered non forestry activity, making forest clearance from the center mandatory. Now, Zoos will be exempted from taking multiple approvals as they are considered forestry activity.

Forest Conservation Act, 1980



- **Compensatory Afforestation:**
- The applicants for diverting forest land in a hilly or mountainous state with green cover covering more than two-thirds of its geographical area, or in a state/UT with forest cover covering more than one-third of its geographical area, will be able to take up compensatory afforestation in other states/UTs where the cover is less than 20%.

Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016



- **Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016**
- The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority (CAMPA) Act seeks to provide an appropriate institutional mechanism, both at the Centre and in each State and Union Territory, to ensure expeditious utilization in the efficient and transparent manner of amounts released in lieu of forest land diverted for the non-forest purpose which would mitigate the impact of diversion of such forest land.
- The CAF Act was passed by the center in 2016 and the related rules were notified in 2018.

Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016



- It seeks to establish the National Compensatory Afforestation Fund under the Public Account of India, and a State Compensatory Afforestation Fund under the Public Account of each state.
- These Funds will receive payments for
- Compensatory afforestation,
- Net present value of forest (NPV), and
- Other project specific payments.
- The National Fund will receive 10% of these funds, and the State Funds will receive the remaining 90%.

HOW CAMPA WORKS?



for every tree : Net present value (N.P.V.)

eg: Rs 100

total → 10,000.

↓
Central CAMPA
U/MOEFC.

₹9,000
to State
CAMPA.

→ will ascertain
where to plant
trees.

Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016



- The funds can be used for:
- Treatment of catchment areas,
- Assisted natural generation,
- Forest management,
- Wildlife protection and management,
- Relocation of villages from protected areas,
- Managing human-wildlife conflicts,
- Training and awareness generation,
- Supply of wood saving devices, and
- Allied activities.

Forest Rights Act, 2006



- The Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006
- The Act provides for the restitution of deprived forest rights across India.
- It provides for integrating conservation and people's livelihood rights and strengthening the local self governance.
- Implemented by Ministry of Tribal Affairs
- Applicable for forest Dwelling Scheduled Tribes (FDST) and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (OTFD) who have been residing in such forests for generations.
- Relate with ethics : Historical Injustices are corrected.

Forest Rights Act, 2006



- For the first time FRA recognizes and secures:
- Community Rights in addition to their Individual Rights
- Right to protect or conserve or manage any community forest resource which the communities have been traditionally protecting & conserving for sustainable use.
- Right to intellectual property and traditional knowledge related to biodiversity and cultural diversity.
- Rights of displaced communities and rights over developmental activities
- The Gram Sabha has been designated as the competent authority for initiating the process of determining the nature and extent of individual or community forest rights.
- The decision of the Gram Sabha to reject or allow claim can be appealed before court.

Forest Rights Act, 2006



- The Act recognizes the right of ownership access to collect, use, and dispose of minor forest produce (it defines Minor Forest Produce to include non-timber forest produce of plant origin) by tribals.
- The rights conferred under the Act shall be heritable but not alienable or transferable.
- National Parks and Sanctuaries have been included along with Reserve Forest, Protected Forests for the recognition of Rights.
- The Act only recognises pre-existing rights which are already being exercised by eligible persons.
- Also, it secures tenure of existing forest dwellers, but no new rights are being created.

Forest Rights Act, 2006



- The FRA act identifies 4 types of rights
- **Title rights:** Gives right to ownership to land farmed forest dwellers subject to a maximum of 4 hectares.
- **Use rights:** Rights of the dwellers extend to extracting Minor Forest Produce, grazing areas, etc.
- **Relief and development rights:** Rehabilitation in case of illegal eviction or forced displacement and to basic amenities, subject to restrictions for forest protection.
- **Forest management rights:** Right to protect, regenerate or conserve or manage any community forest resource which they have been traditionally protecting and conserving for sustainable use.

Forest Rights Act, 2006



- Criteria and evidence for Forest Dwelling Scheduled Tribes (FDST) to claim rights under FRA:
- Must be ST in an area.
- Primarily resided in forest or land prior to Dec 2005
- Depend on forest or forest land for livelihood needs
- Criteria for other Traditional Forest Dweller (OFTD) to claim rights under FRA:
- Primarily resided in forest for 3 generation (75 years) prior to December 2005.
- Depend on forest for livelihood needs.

Forest Rights Act, 2006



- **Critical Wildlife Habitats (CWH)**
- The Critical Wildlife Habitats (CWH) have been envisaged in Forest Rights Act, 2006.
- CWH are defined under the act as the “areas of national parks and sanctuaries which are required to be kept as inviolate (human settlement and usage) for the purposes of wildlife conservation”.
- FRA identifies Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change as the agency to notify the guidelines related to Critical Wildlife Habitats (CWH).

Forest Rights Act, 2006



- **Critical Wildlife Habitats (CWH) vs Core or critical tiger habitat**
- The phrase 'core or critical tiger habitat' is mentioned only in the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, as a sequel to amendment made to the said Act in 2006. It is NOT defined in the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006.
- The phrase 'critical wildlife habitat' is defined only in the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006, and NOT in the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.

Forest Rights Act, 2006



- **Habitat Rights to PVTGs**
- Certain tribes are called PVTGs based on their greater vulnerability classified as such after Dhebar Commission highlighted inequalities among tribals.
- Criteria :
- Pre agricultural level of technology.
- Extremely low literacy.
- Stagnant, declining population.
- Subsistence based economy.
- Forest dependent livelihood.

Forest Rights Act, 2006



- 75 PVTGs distributed among 18 states and UTs of India.
- The communities were identified based on the recommendations of Tribal Research Institutes (TRIs) of the respective state governments and by 1993-94, 75 groups had been identified and placed on the list of PTGs. Odisha houses for 13 PVTGs which is the highest among all the states.
- The historic Forest Rights Act of 2006 for the first time provided scope for the recognition of the PVTGs' forest and habitat rights.
- 'Rights including community tenures of habitat and habitation for primitive tribal groups and pre-agricultural communities'.
- Baigas were the first PVTG in India to be granted habitat rights.

Forest Rights Act, 2006



- Diversion of forest land for non forest purposes only on recommendation of gram sabha
- resettlement of tribals in case of critical wildlife area only if no other option available, free informed consent of gram sabha and land allocation at resettlement location is complete.
- First tier to process claims is the gram sabha to ensure that tribals don't have to directly face legalism.

Community Forest Rights



- **Context:**
- Chhattisgarh recognized community forest rights (CFR) of the tribals of the Kanger Ghati National Park (KNP).
- Community Forest Right area is common forest land that has been traditionally protected and conserved for sustainable use by a particular community.
- May include forest of any category – revenue forest, classified & unclassified forest, deemed forest, reserve forest, protected forest, sanctuary and national parks etc.

Community Forest Rights



- They are recognised under the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act (FRA), 2006 which:
- Recognize and vest the forest rights and occupation in forest land in forest dwelling Scheduled Tribes and other traditional forest dwellers who have been residing in such forests for generations but whose right could not be recorded.
- Allow the community to formulate rules for forest use by itself and others.
- Give the authority to the Gram Sabha to adopt local traditional practices of forest conservation and management within the community forest resource boundary.

Section 2(4) of the [Indian Forest Act 1927](#) defines only "forest-produce" and this term connotes to those products whether found in, or brought from a forest such as

- a. timber, charcoal, caoutchouc, catechu, wood-oil, resin, natural varnish, bark, lac, mahua flowers, mahua seeds, kuth and myrabolams,
- b. trees and leaves, flowers and fruits, and all other parts or produce of trees,
- c. plants not being trees (including grass, creepers, reeds and moss), and all parts or produce of such plants,
- d. wild animals and skins, tusks, horns, bones, silk, cocoons, honey and wax, and all other parts or produce of animals, and
- e. peat, surface soil, rock and minerals (including lime-stone, laterite, mineral oils), and all products of mines or quarries;

Forest Produce



In short, the essential condition to be qualified as a forest produce is that the products should be either found in or be brought from forest.

Minor Forest Produce (MFP) is a subset of forest produce and got a definition only in 2007 when the [Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers \(Recognition of Forest Rights\) Act, 2006](#), was enacted. Section 2(i) of the said Act defines a Minor Forest Produce (MFP) as all non-timber forest produce of plant origin and includes bamboo, brushwood, stumps, canes, Tusser, cocoon, honey, waxes, Lac, tendu/kendu leaves, medicinal plants and herbs, roots, tuber and the like.

Thus, the definition of “minor forest produce” includes bamboo and cane, thereby changing the categorization of bamboo and cane as “trees” under the Indian Forest Act 1927.

India State of Forest Report, 2021



- Assessment of India's forest and tree cover, published every two years by the Forest Survey of India (under MoEFCC)
- ISFR 2021 is the 17th report
- New things in 17th Report :
- Assessment in tiger reserves and tiger corridor
- above ground biomass estimation using synthetic aperture radar data in collaboration with ISRO
- Mapping of Climate Change hotspots in Indian Forests in collaboration with BITS pilani.

India State of Forest Report, 2021



- **Definitions in ISFR**
- Recorded Forest Area (RFA)- any lands notified as forest under any Government Act or Rules (A RFA may or may not have a forest)
- Forest Cover- all patches of land with a tree canopy density of more than 10% and more than 1 ha in area, irrespective of land use (agroforestry, compensatory forestry), ownership (public or private), and species of trees (it can even be a plantation).
- FAO definition does not include agriculture and plantation land as it doesn't support biodiversity. Recent Indian Express Investigation.

India State of Forest Report, 2021



- Tree Cover- all patches of trees less than 1 ha outside RFA. (irrespective of Canopy density)
- Trees Outside Forests (TOF)- all trees outside RFA irrespective of patch size. (Tree Cover is a subset of TOF)

India State of Forest Report, 2021



- Clarification:
- In Recorded Forest Areas, there are areas with a density of less than 10% and some even without trees.
- On the other hand, there are areas outside the Recorded Forest Areas with tree stands of more than 10% canopy density and size 1 ha or more, such areas also constitute forest cover.
- Therefore, the change in the forest cover is not necessarily due to changes within the Recorded Forest Areas but also outside Recorded Forest Areas

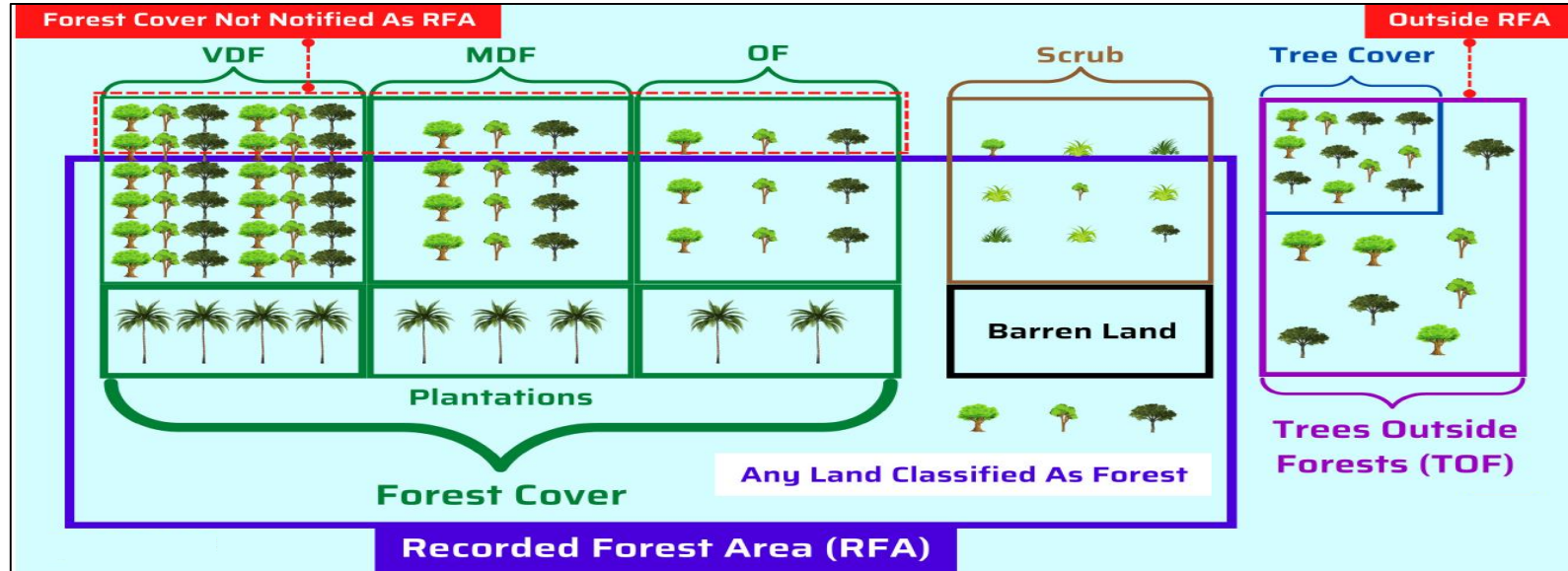
India State of Forest Report, 2021



- Density based classification

Forest Cover	Canopy Density
Very Dense Forest (VDF)	>70%
Moderately Dense Forest (MDF)	40-70%
Open Forest (OF)	10-40%
Scrub	<10%
Non-forest	Any area not included in the above classes

India State of Forest Report, 2021



India State of Forest Report, 2021



Class (GA: Geographical Area)	ISFR 2019		ISFR 2021	
	Area (km ²)	% of GA	Area (km ²)	% of GA
Very Dense Forest (VDF – tree canopy density $\geq 70\%$)	99278	3.02	99,779	3.04 (↑)
Moderately Dense Forest (MDF – tree canopy density $\geq 40\%$ but $< 70\%$)	3,08,472	9.38	3,06,890	9.33 (↓)
Open Forest (OF – tree canopy density $\geq 10\%$ but $< 40\%$)	3,04,499	9.26	3,07,120	9.34 (↑)
Total Forest Cover (Mangroves + VDF + MDF + OF)	7,12,249	21.67	7,13,789	21.71 (↑)
Tree Cover	95,027	2.89	95,748	2.91 (↑)
Total Forest and Tree Cover	8,07,276	24.56	8,09,537	24.62 (↑)
Scrub (forest with canopy density $< 10\%$)	46,297	1.41	46,539	1.42 (↑)
Non-Forest (Tree Cover + Water Bodies + Land not under Forest Cover)	25,28,923	76.92	25,27,141	76.87 (↓)
Total Geographic Area	32,87,269	100	32,87,469	100
VDF and MDF constitute 57 per cent of the total Forest Cover. (VDF + MDF > OF)				

India State of Forest Report, 2021



Forest Cover

State/UT	2021 Forest Cover in sq km			Total	% of GA	% Change w.r.t 2019
	VDF	MDF	OF			
GA: Geographical Area; Area is in sq km						
1 Madhya Pradesh	6,665	34,209	36,619	77,493	25 (20)	11
2 Arunachal Pradesh	21,058	30,176	15,197	66,431	79 (4)	-257
3 Chhattisgarh	7,068	32,279	16,370	55,717	41 (13)	106
4 Odisha	7,213	20,995	23,948	52,156	34 (17)	537
5 Maharashtra	8,734	20,589	21,475	50,798	17 (27)	20
6 Karnataka	4,533	20,985	13,212	38,730	20 (22)	155

India State of Forest Report, 2021



- Forest Cover as percentage of Gross Area- Lakshadweep (90%), Mizoram (85%), A&N Islands (82%), Arunachal Pradesh (79%), Meghalaya (76%), Manipur (74%), Nagaland (74%), Tripura (74%), Goa (61%), Kerala (55%)
- States with a positive change in FC: Andhra Pradesh (647 sq km), Telangana, Odisha, Karnataka and Jharkhand (110 sq km).
- States with a negative change in FC: Arunachal Pradesh (257 sq km), Manipur, Nagaland, Mizoram & Meghalaya (73 sq km)
- Cities
- Delhi has the largest Forest Cover (194 sq km), followed by Mumbai (111 sq km), Bengaluru (89 sq km), Hyderabad (82 sq km), Chennai (23 sq km), Ahmedabad (9.4 sq km) and Kolkata (1.7 sq km).

- **New York Declaration**
- The New York Declaration on Forests is a voluntary and non-legally binding political declaration which grew out of dialogue among governments, companies and civil society, spurred by the United Nations Secretary-General's Climate Summit held in New York in 2014.
- The Declaration pledges to halve the rate of deforestation by 2020, to end it by 2030, and to restore hundreds of millions of acres of degraded land.
- Presently, India has not signed the New York Declaration on Forests (NYDF).

Forest Related Information



- **‘Tree City of the World’ (TCW) Tag**
- Mumbai and Hyderabad have been jointly recognised as ‘2021 TCW’.
- TCW programme has been started by United Nations’ Food and Agriculture Organisation and American non-profit organisation Arbor Day Foundation.
- Provides direction, assistance, and worldwide recognition for a community’s dedication to its urban forest and framework for healthy, sustainable urban forestry programme in town or city.
- City was evaluated based on five standards i.e. Establish Responsibility, Set the Rules, Know What You Have, Allocate the Resources, and Celebrate the Achievements.

Forest Related Information



- **Nagar Van Scheme**
- Launched in 2020, on World Environment Day (5th June) to develop 400 Urban Forests (Nagar Van) and 200 Nagar Vatika across the country in the next five years.
- Nodal ministry- Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- Under the scheme
- A minimum of 20 hectares of forests will be created in the city.
- Forests will come up either on existing forest land or on any other vacant land offered by urban local bodies.
- Van Udyan once established will be maintained by the State Government.
- Fully funded by the under CAMPA (Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016) funds.

- **Miyawaki Method**
- It is a technique of urban afforestation by creating micro forests over small plots of land.
- Devised by Japanese botanist Akira Miyawaki in 1980s.
- Ensures 10 times faster growth of plant and 30 times denser than usual.
- In this technique, native trees of region are divided into four layers (shrub, sub-tree, tree, and canopy) after identification and analysis of soil quality.

Where to use this in mains?



- 2013 Mains : question on urban heat islands.
- Society (GS 1) : urbanisation is part of the syllabus, so any question on urbanisation, write urban heat island as one of the problems, nagar van scheme / miyawaki as one of the solutions.
- Similar : Local governance and 3F : problem, TULIP programme as innovative solution.
- In conclusion : Use SDG 11 : sustainable cities and communities.

Biological Diversity Act, 2002



- It was enacted to provide for:
- The conservation of biological diversity,
- Sustainable use of its components
- Fair and equitable sharing of the benefits arising out of the use of biological resources and knowledge.
- Fulfill India's obligations under the Convention of Biological Diversity and Nagoya Protocol on Access and Benefit Sharing.
- Which article? Think?
- CBD recognises that Genetic Resources of a state are its sovereign rights.

Biological Diversity Act, 2002



- The act envisaged a three-tier structure to regulate the access to biological resources:
- The National Biodiversity Authority (NBA)
- The State Biodiversity Boards (SBBs)
- The Biodiversity Management Committees (BMCs) (at local level)
- People's biodiversity register : maintained by BMC with help of gram sabha, contains information about local flora and fauna, climate, landscape, agriculture and traditional knowledge.
- NBA has powers of a civil court

Biological Diversity Act, 2002



- Before applying for any form of IPRs (Intellectual Property Rights) in or outside India for an invention based on research on a biological resource obtained from India, prior approval of National Biodiversity Authority will be required.
- While granting approvals, National Biodiversity Authority will impose terms and conditions to secure equitable sharing of benefits.
- The monetary benefits, fees, royalties as a result of approvals by National Biodiversity Authority will be deposited in National Biodiversity Fund.
- NBF will be used for conservation and development of areas from where resource has been accessed, in consultation with the local self-government concerned.

Biological Diversity Act, 2002



- Results of research not to be transferred to Foreign citizens, NRIs, and foreign companies without the approval of National Biodiversity Authority.
- The act excludes traditional uses of Indian biological resources and associated knowledge
- Under Section 37 of Biological Diversity Act, 2002 the State Government in consultation with local bodies may notify the areas of biodiversity importance as Biodiversity Heritage Sites.
- Indian citizens / entities / local people including vaid and hakims have free access to use biological resources within the country for their own use, medicinal purposes and research purposes.

Biological Diversity Act, 2002



- Biodiversity Heritage Sites (BHSs)
- Well defined areas that are unique, ecologically fragile ecosystems, spread over terrestrial, coastal and inland and marine waters having rich biodiversity.
- Notified by: State Governments, in consultation with ‘local bodies’
- Creation of BHSs may not put any restriction on prevailing practices and usages of local communities, other than those voluntarily decided by them.
- State Governments are also empowered to frame schemes for compensating or rehabilitating any person or section of people economically affected by such notification.

Biological Diversity Act, 2002



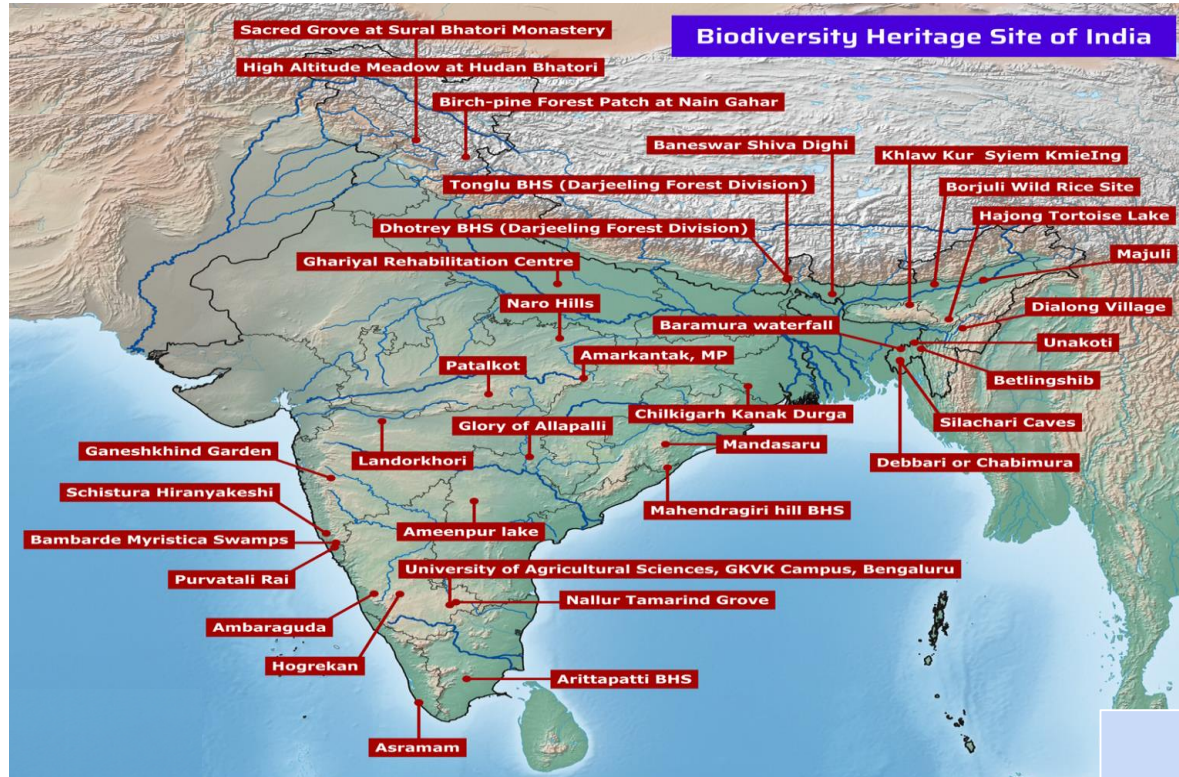
- Components
- Richness of wild as well as domesticated species or intra-specific categories.
- High endemism.
- Presence of rare and threatened species, keystone species, species of evolutionary significance.
- Wild ancestors of domestic/cultivated species or their varieties.
- Past pre-eminence of biological components represented by fossil beds and having significant cultural, ethical or aesthetic values and are important for the maintenance of cultural diversity, with or without a long history of human association with them.

Biological Diversity Act, 2002



- Presently 36 BHS are in India including Majuli, Unakoti, Silachari Caves, Amarkantak etc.
- First Biodiversity Heritage Site of India- Nallur Tamarind Grove in Bengaluru, Karnataka (2007).
- Recently, Tamil Nadu issued a notification declaring Arittapatti and Meenakshipuram villages in Madurai district the first biodiversity heritage site in State.

Biological Diversity Act, 2002



Water Act, 1971



- The Water (Prevention And Control Of Pollution) Act, 1974
- Aim- Prevention and control of water pollution and maintaining or restoring of wholesomeness and purity of water
- Background of the Act
- Since water is a state subject, the Act was enacted based on the Resolution of the Legislatures of 12 States, invoking Article 252 of the Constitution as in the case of the Wild Life Act

Water Act, 1971



- Act vests regulatory authority in State Pollution Control Boards and empowers these Boards to establish and enforce effluent standards for factories discharging pollutants into water bodies.
- A Central Pollution Control Board performs the same functions for Union Territories and formulate policies and coordinates activities of different State Boards.
- The 1988 amendment act empowered SPCB and CPCB to directly close a defaulting industrial plant.

Air Act, 1981



- The Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act of 1981 and amendment, 1987
- Background of the Act
- To implement the decisions taken at the UN Conference on the Human Environment held at Stockholm in 1972, Parliament enacted the nationwide Air Act.
- The Air Act expanded the authority of the central and state boards established under the Water Act, to include air pollution control.
- The 1987 amendment introduced a citizen's suit provision into the Air Act and extended the Act to include noise pollution

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- Background of the Act
- It was enacted in the wake of Bhopal Gas Tragedy
- It was passed by Parliament claiming legislative competence under Article 253 of the Constitution.
- The Act cites the decision of the Stockholm Conference with regard to appropriate steps for “protection and improvement of the environment and the prevention of hazards to human beings, other living creatures, plants and property”.

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- The purpose of the Act is to act as an “umbrella” legislation designed to provide a framework for Central government co- ordination of the activities of various central and state authorities established under previous laws, such as Water Act and Air Act.
- Central Government gets full power for the purpose of protecting and improving the quality of the environment.
- The powers include:
 - Coordination of action by state,
 - Planning and execution of nationwide programmes,
 - Laying down environmental quality standards, especially those governing emission or discharge of environmental pollutants.

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- Placing restriction on the location of industries and so on.
- Authority to issue direct orders, included orders to close, prohibits or regulate any industry.
- Power of entry for examination, testing of equipment and other purposes and power to analyse the sample of air, water, soil or any other substance from any place.
- Preparation of codes, guides and manuals.
- Such other matters as central government deems necessary or expedient for purpose of securing the effective implementation of act (this provision truly makes it an umbrella legislation).

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- The Act provides provisions for penalties. For each failure or contravention, the punishment included a prison term up to 5 years or fine up to Rs. 1 lakh, or both.
- Section 19 provides that any person, in addition to authorized government officials, may file a complaint with a court alleging an offence under the Act.
- This “Citizens’ Suit” provision requires that the person has to give notice of not less than 60 days of the alleged offence of pollution to the Central Government.

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- Section 3:
- Empowers government to constitute authority/s for the purpose of exercising powers and performing such functions (as conferred by the Act)
- Central Groundwater Authority
- Taj Trapezium Zone Pollution (Prevention and Control) Authority 2003
- Environment Pollution(Prevention and Control) Authority for the NCR : now replaced by NCAQM (not formed under this act)

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- Important legislations notified under this Act:
- E-Waste Management Rules, 2022
- Solid Waste Management, 2016 Rules
- Bio-Medical Waste Management Rules, 2016
- CRZ Rules
- Wetland (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2017
- The Ozone Depleting Substance Rules
- Plastic Waste Management Rules, 2016 (amended in 2018, 2021, 2022)

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- **Ecologically Sensitive Zones**
- Ecologically important and fragile areas around protected areas
- Notified by: The Central Government in exercise of the powers conferred by section 3 of the Environment Protection Act, 1986.
- Extent of ESZs as per 2011 guidelines: Generally, width of up to 10 kms around a PA.
- Create some kind of “Shock Absorber” for the Protected Areas (PAs) and avoid man animal conflict.
- Recently SC directed every protected forest, national park and wildlife sanctuary in the country should mandatorily have a minimum 1 km ESZ,

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- **Ecologically Sensitive Zones**
- Core and buffer model of management
- Core area : legal status of national park, buffer area has no such status and is meant to serve as transition.
- Includes sensitive corridors, connectivity and ecologically important patches, landscape linkages, may go beyond 10km also.

CATEGORIES OF ACTIVITIES UNDERTAKEN WITHIN AN ESZ



Prohibited

Commercial mining, setting of saw mills, polluting industries, major hydroelectric projects etc.



Regulated

Felling of trees, Establishment of hotels and resorts, drastic change of agriculture system, widening of roads, introduction of exotic species etc.



Permissible

Rainwater Harvesting, Organic farming, Ongoing Agricultural and Horticulture practices by local communities, Adoption of green technology for all activities etc.

PROCEDURE OF DECLARATION OF ESZ



Creation of inventory

Inventory of activities
● around each of the Protected Area as well as important Corridors is made with the help of range officers.



Constitution of a committee

- The committee is tasked with demarcating extent of ESZ and create a Master Plan for its management (including classification of activities to be regulated).
- The committee generally comprises of: Wildlife Warden, Warden, an Ecologist and officials from local self-government and Revenue Department.

ESZ

Notification of ESZ

- Final proposal is forwarded to the MoEFCC for further processing and notification.



Environment Protection Act, 1986



- **Western Ghats**
- Gadgil panel (2011) recommended tagging 64% of the Western Ghats region as an Ecologically Sensitive Area (ESA) with varying degrees.
- Later Kasturirangan committee (2013) was appointed that proposed 37% total area of Western Ghats, to be declared as ESA.
- Continued the existing system of 'red', 'orange' and 'green' categorisation of activities according to their polluting effects.
- It recommended a blanket ban on mining, quarrying, setting up of red category industries and thermal power projects
- news : SC has quashed a plea against the reports of Kasturirangan and Gadgil panels

Environment Protection Act, 1986



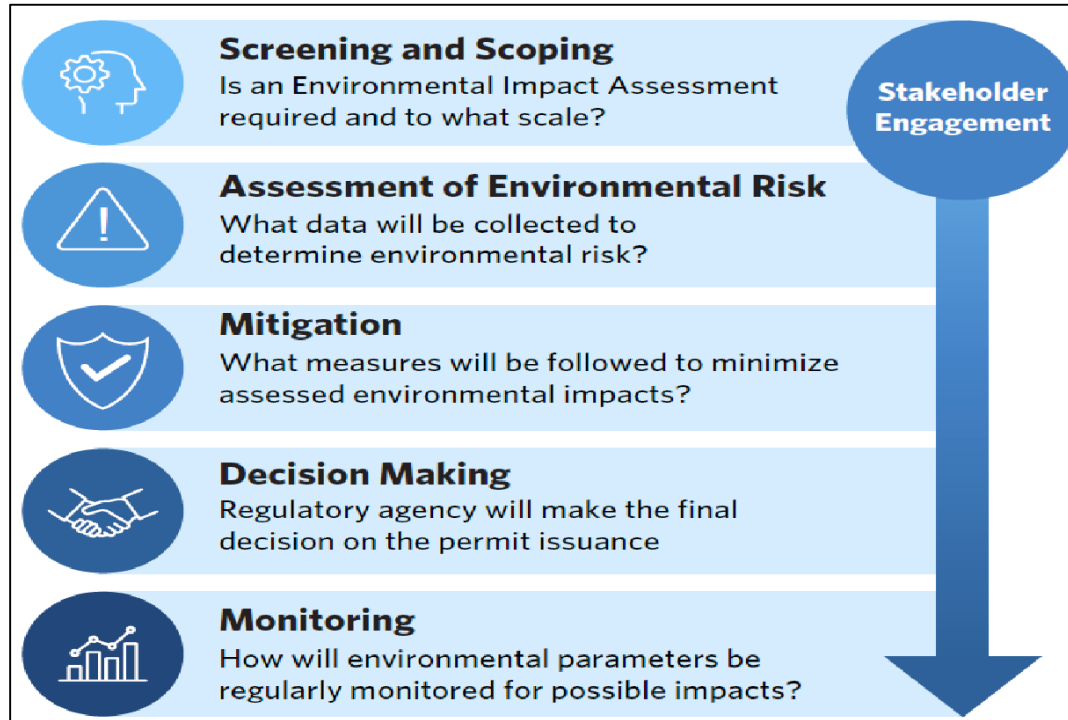
- **Western Ghats**
 - news : SC has quashed a plea against the reports of Kasturirangan and Gadgil panels
 - To resolve the conflict in the two reports, kerala government proposed to implement the Oommen v Oomen report that recommended that plantations and inhabited areas in WG be kept out of ESA.

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- **Environment Impact Assessment**
- It is a tool to anticipate the likely environmental impacts that may arise out of the proposed developmental activities and suggest mitigation measures and strategies.
- It was introduced in India in 1978, with respect to river valley projects.
- It was later enhanced to include other developmental sections.
- It is now mandatory for more than 30 categories of projects, and these projects get Environmental Clearance (EC) only after the EIA requirements are fulfilled.

Environment Protection Act, 1986



Environment Protection Act, 1986



- Steps involved:
- Screening: the project plan is screened for scale of investment, location and type of development and if the project needs statutory clearance.
- Scoping: identifying the project's potential impacts, zone of impacts, mitigation possibilities and need for monitoring needs to be worked out.
- Collection of baseline data (environmental status of study area).
- Impact prediction: positive and negative, reversible and irreversible and temporary and permanent impacts need to be predicted.
- Mitigation measures: the EIA report should include the actions and steps for preventing, minimizing or bypassing the impacts or else the level of compensation for probable environmental damage or loss.

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- Public hearing: On completion of the EIA report, public and environmental groups living close to project site may be informed and consulted.
- Decision making: Impact Assessment Authority along with the experts consult the project-in-charge to take the final decision, keeping in mind EIA and Environment Management Plan (EMP).
- Monitoring and implementation of EMP
- Assessment of Alternatives, Delineation of Mitigation Measures and EIA Report
- Mitigation plan: Once alternatives have been reviewed, a mitigation plan should be drawn up for the selected option and is supplemented with an Environmental Management Plan (EMP).
- Risk assessment: Inventory analysis and hazard probability and index also form part of EIA procedures.

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- Environment Impact Assessment Notification of 2006 has decentralized the environmental clearance projects by categorizing the developmental projects in two categories:
 1. Category A (national level appraisal)
 2. Category B (state level appraisal).
- Category A projects are appraised at national level by Impact Assessment Agency (IAA) and the Expert Appraisal Committee (EAC).
- Category B projects are appraised at state level. State Level Environment IAA and State Level EAC are constituted for the purpose.
- Category B projects undergoes screening process, and they are classified into two types:
 1. Category B1 projects (Mandatorily requires EIA).
 2. Category B2 projects (Do not require EIA/Environmental Clearance).

Environment Protection Act, 1986



- After the 2006 Amendment, the EIA cycle comprises of four stages
 1. Screening,
 2. Scoping,
 3. Public hearing
 4. Appraisal

Coastal Regulation Zone (CRZ) Rules



- In accordance with the Environment Protection Act of 1986, the Environment Ministry created the Coastal Regulation Zone rules (CRZ rules) in February 1991.
- In 2018, the government released the Coastal Regulation Zone Notification 2018 to lift building limitations, speed up the clearance procedure, and boost tourism in coastal areas.
- The National Coastal zone management authority and state coastal zone management authority are created for enforcement and monitoring of CRZ rules, under EPA, 1986.
- Division
- CRZ- I areas are those which are environmentally most critical. These are further classified as:

Coastal Regulation Zone (CRZ) Rules



- CRZ-I A constitutes ecologically sensitive areas (ESAs) and geomorphological features which play a role in maintaining the integrity of coast. These include mangroves; coral reefs etc
- CRZ-I B constitutes the intertidal zone, i.e, land area between the High Tide Line (HTL) and the Low Tide Line (LTL).
- CRZ-II constitutes the developed land areas which are substantially built-up with drainage and other infrastructural facilities or legally designated urban areas.

Coastal Regulation Zone (CRZ) Rules



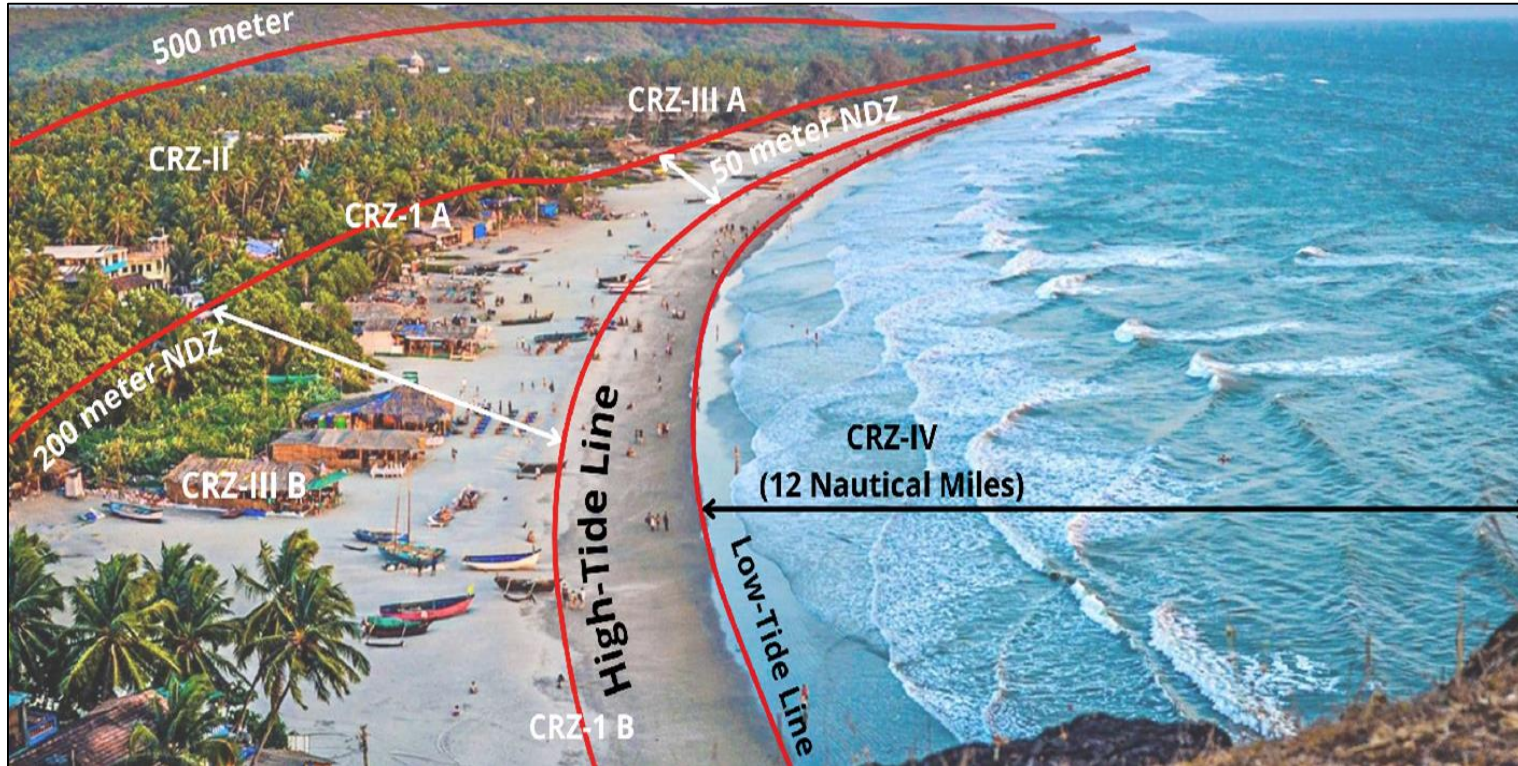
- CRZ-III are the land areas that are relatively undisturbed, i.e, the rural areas and which do not fall under CRZ-II.
- CRZ-III are further classified as
- CRZ-III A- are the areas with population density more than 2161 per sq. km as per 2011 census.
- In CRZ-III A, area upto 50 meters from the HTL on the landward side is marked as the No Development Zone (NDZ).
- CRZ-III B- are the areas with population density less than 2161 per sq. km as per 2011 census.
- In CRZ-III B, area upto 200 meters from the HTL on the landward side is marked as the No Development Zone (NDZ).

Coastal Regulation Zone (CRZ) Rules



- CRZ-IV- constitutes the water area and is further classified as a.
- CRZ-IV A- the water area between the LTL upto 12 nautical miles on the seaward side.
- CRZ-IV B- Tidal influenced water bodies.
- Projects which are located in the CRZ-I (Ecologically Sensitive Areas) and CRZ IV (area covered between Low Tide Line and 12 Nautical Miles seaward) will be dealt with for CRZ clearance by the MoEF.
- The powers for clearances with respect to CRZ-II and III have been delegated at the State level.

Coastal Regulation Zone (CRZ) Rules



National Green Tribunal Act, 2010



- The Act provides for the establishment of a National Green Tribunal for the effective and expeditious disposal of cases relating to environmental protection. Enacted under article 21 : ensures right to healthy environment.
- The specialized architecture of the NGT will facilitate fast track resolution of environmental cases and provide a boost to the implementation of many sustainable development measures.
- NGT is mandated to dispose the cases within 6 months of their respective appeals.
- Principal Bench of the NGT has been established in New Delhi
- Regional benches in Pune (Western Zone Bench), Bhopal (Central Zone Bench), Chennai (Southern Bench) and Kolkata (Eastern Bench).

National Green Tribunal Act, 2010



- Members
- Sanctioned strength of the tribunal is currently 10 expert members + 10 judicial members although the act allows for up to 20 of each.
- Every bench of tribunal must consist of at least 1 expert member & 1 judicial member.
- The Chairman of the tribunal is required to be a serving or retired Chief Justice of a High Court or a judge of the Supreme Court of India.

National Green Tribunal Act, 2010



- The Tribunal has Original Jurisdiction on matters of “substantial question relating to environment” (i.e. a community at large is affected, damage to public health at broader level) and “damage to environment due to specific activity” (such as pollution). Term substantial is undefined.
- The NGT has the power to hear all civil cases relating to environmental issues and questions that are linked to the implementation of laws listed in Schedule I of the NGT Act.
- These include the following:
 - The Water (Control of Pollution) Act, 1974;
 - The Water (Control of Pollution) Cess Act, 1977;
 - The Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980;

National Green Tribunal Act, 2010



- The Air (Prevention & Control of Pollution) Act, 1981;
- The Environment (Protection) Act, 1986;
- The Public Liability Insurance Act, 1991;
- The Biological Diversity Act, 2002.
- NGT **has not** been vested with powers to hear any matter relating to:
- Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.
- Indian Forest Act, 1927.
- Various laws enacted by states relating to forests, tree preservation etc.

National Green Tribunal Act, 2010



- The Tribunal's orders are binding, and it has power to grant relief in the form of compensation and damages to affected persons.
- It is not bound by the procedure laid down under the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908, but shall be guided by principles of natural justice.
- It is also not bound by the rules of evidence as enshrined in the Indian Evidence Act, 1872.
- The order of National Green Tribunal can be challenged before the Supreme Court within 90 days.
- NGT applies the principles of sustainable development, precautionary principle and polluter pays principles in its orders.

National Green Tribunal Act, 2010



- Strict Liability vs Absolute Liability
- Strict Liability Principle: a party is not liable and need not pay compensation if a hazardous substance escapes its premises by accident or by an 'act of God' among other circumstances.
- Absolute Liability Principle: a party in a hazardous industry cannot claim any exemption. It has to mandatorily pay compensation, whether or not the disaster was caused by its negligence.
- The National Green Tribunal Act of 2010 incorporates the absolute liability principle.
- NGT act mandates that the absolute liability should be applied even if the disaster caused is an accident.

Protection of Plant Varieties & Farmers' Rights (PPVFR) Act, 2001



- It has been enacted in India for giving effect to the TRIPS Agreement.
- The PPVFR Act retained the main spirit of TRIPS viz., IPRs as an incentive for technological innovation.
- However, the Act also had strong provisions to protect farmers' rights.
- The act allows farmers to plant, grow, exchange & sell patent-protected crops, including seeds, & only bars them from selling it as “branded seed”.
- It recognised three roles for the farmer: cultivator, breeder & conserver.
- As cultivators, farmers were entitled to plant-back rights.
- As breeders, farmers were held equivalent to plant breeders.
- As conservers, farmers were entitled to rewards from a National Gene Fund.

Protection of Plant Varieties & Farmers' Rights (PPVFR) Act, 2001



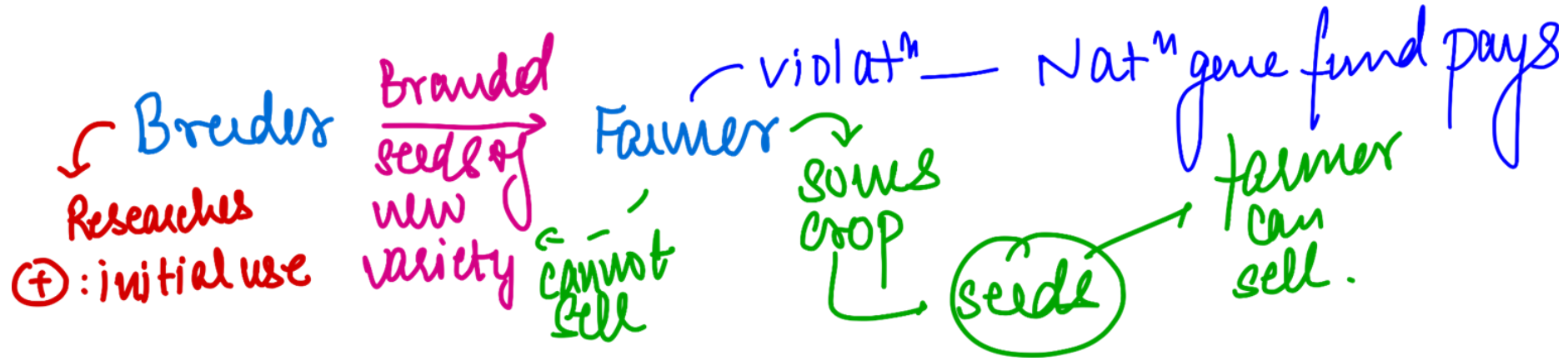
- World's only IPR legislation that grants IPR not only to plant breeders but also to the farmers.
- Implementation authority : PPV&FR authority under ministry of agriculture. It registers new plant varieties, develops standards, maintains national gene bank.
- Criteria : Distinctiveness, Uniformity and Stability : seed is eligible for registration under the act if it fulfills these criteria. Seeds get IPR, not patents.
- Registrable plant varieties : New, Extant, Farmers, Essentially derived variety.

Protection of Plant Varieties & Farmers' Rights (PPVFR) Act, 2001



Breeders' Rights	• Exclusive rights to produce, sell, market, distribute, import or export the protected/ registered variety. • Can appoint agent/ licensee and may exercise civil remedy in case of infringement of rights.
Researchers' Rights	• Can use any of the registered variety under the Act for conducting experiment or research. • This includes the use of a variety as an initial source of variety for the purpose of developing another variety but repeated use needs prior permission of the registered breeder.
Farmers' Rights	• A farmer who has evolved or developed a new variety is entitled for registration and protection in like manner as a breeder of a variety. • Section 39(1) of the Act allows all farmers cultivating a registered new variety the right to "save, use, sow, resow, exchange, share or sell farm produce including seeds" except the branded seeds. • Section 39 (2) of the Act provides for compensation to the farmers for non-performance of variety. • Farmer shall not be liable to pay any fee in any proceeding before the Authority or Registrar or the Tribunal or the High Court under the Act. It will be paid through National Gene Fund.

Protection of Plant Varieties & Farmers' Rights (PPVFR) Act, 2001



National Board For Wildlife



- It is a Statutory Organization constituted under the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972.
- It was constituted in 2003 replacing Indian Board For Wildlife (IBWL)
- Primary function of the Board is to promote the conservation and development of wildlife and forests.
- It serves as apex body to review all wildlife-related matters and approve projects in and around national parks and sanctuaries.
- No alteration of boundaries in National Parks and Wildlife Sanctuaries can be done without approval of the NBWL.
- It is a 47-members body chaired by the Prime Minister and its vice chairman is the Minister of Environment.

Animal Welfare Board of India



- Established in 1962 under the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960.
- Started under the stewardship of Late Smt. Rukmini Devi Arundale.
- Government has shifted headquarters of Animal Welfare Board of India (AWBI) to Ballabhgarh in Faridabad District of Haryana from Chennai, Tamil Nadu.
- The Board was initially within the jurisdiction of the GOI's Ministry of Food and Agriculture. And later in 1990, the subject of Prevention of Cruelty to Animals was transferred to the Ministry of Environment and Forests.

Animal Welfare Board of India



- Functions of Animal Welfare Board of India:
- ensures that animal welfare laws in the country are diligently followed, to provide grants to Animal Welfare Organizations
- suggests changes to laws and rules about animal welfare issues.
- issues publications to raise awareness of various animal welfare issues.
- Recognises Animal Welfare Organisations

Wildlife Institute of India (WII)



- Established as an attached office in May, 1982.
- Granted autonomous status under the MoEFCC in 1985.
- Function: conducts specialised research in areas of study like Endangered Species, Biodiversity, Wildlife Management, Wildlife Policy, Wildlife Forensics, Habitat Ecology, Spatial Modelling, Eco-development, and Climate Change.
- WII has a research facility which includes Forensics, Remote Sensing and GIS, Laboratory, Herbarium, and an Electronic Library.



Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)



- It is a statutory organization that was constituted in September 1974 under the Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974.
- CPCB was entrusted with the powers and functions under the Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981.
- Functions of the CPCB:
- To promote cleanliness of streams and wells in different areas of the States through prevention, control, and abatement of water pollution, and
- To improve the quality of air and to prevent, control or abate air pollution in the country.
- It also provides technical services to the Ministry of Environment and Forests regarding the provisions of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986.

Forest Survey of India (FSI)



- It is an organization under the Ministry of Environment Forest & Climate Change.
- Responsible for assessment and monitoring of the forest resources of the country regularly.
- Established in 1981.
- Headquartered at Dehradun.
- ISFR- India State of Forest Report is a biennial publication of Forest Survey of India (FSI), an organization under the Ministry of Environment Forest & Climate Change, since 1987.



National Tiger Conservation Authority



- It is a statutory body constituted under the WPA, 1972 for tiger conservation.
- It is headed by the minister of Ministry of Environment Forest & Climate Change.
- The Authority has three Members of Parliament of whom two will be elected by the House of the People and one by the Council of States.
- It also has eight experts or professionals having qualifications and experience in wildlife conservation and welfare of people including Tribals.
- The Inspector General of Forests, in charge of project Tiger, is the ex-officio Member Secretary.

National Biodiversity Authority



- The National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) was established in 2003 by the Central Government to implement India's Biological Diversity Act (2002).
- It is a Statutory body, headquartered in Chennai.
- It performs a facilitative, regulatory and advisory function for the Government of India on the issue of Conservation, sustainable use of biological resources and fair equitable sharing of benefits of use.
- The Biological diversity Act (2002) mandates implementation of the provisions of the Act through decentralized system.

Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB)



- WCCB is a statutory body established by the GOI under the MoEFCC, to combat organized wildlife crime in the country.
- It is the nodal agency in India for CITES related enforcements.
- It is also the nodal point for South Asia Wildlife Enforcement Network (SAWEN) in India
- Regional inter-governmental wildlife law enforcement support body launched in January, 2011 in Paro, Bhutan.
- United Nation Environment has awarded Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB), with Asia Environment Enforcement Awards, 2018 for excellent work done by the Bureau in combating transboundary environmental crime.



Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB)



- Mandate under Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972:
- Collect and collate intelligence related to organized wildlife crime activities and to disseminate
- the same to State and other enforcement agencies;
- Establish a centralized wildlife crime data bank;
- Co-ordinate actions by various agencies in connection with the enforcement of the provisions of the Act;
- Assist foreign authorities and international organization concerned for wildlife crime control;
- Capacity building of the wildlife crime enforcement agencies for investigation into wildlife crimes and assist State Governments to ensure success in prosecutions related to wildlife crimes; and
- Advise the Government of India on issues relating to wildlife crimes

Botanical Survey of India



- It is the apex research organization under Ministry of Environment Forest and Climate Change for carrying out taxonomic and floristic studies on wild plant resources of the country.
- It was established in 1890..
- Headquarters- Kolkata
- Functions
- Publication of National, State and District Floras.
- Identification of threatened and red list species and species rich areas needing conservation.
- Ex-situ conservation of critically threatened species in botanical gardens.
- Survey and documentation of traditional knowledge (ethno-botany) associated with plants.
- Develop National database of Indian plants, including herbarium and live specimens, botanical paintings and illustrations, etc.

Central Zoo Authority



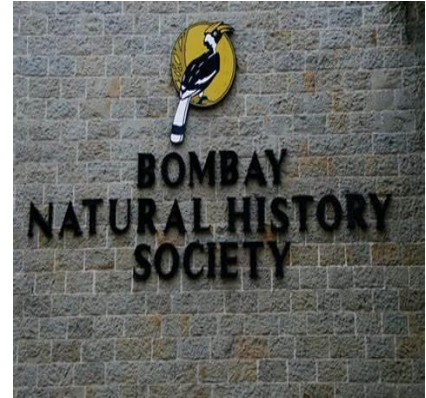
- The Central Zoo Authority of India (CZA) is the body of the government of India responsible for oversight of zoos.
- Headquarters: Delhi
- It is an affiliate member of the World Association of Zoos and Aquariums.
- It is a Statutory body, constituted under the Wild Life (Protection) Act.
- Central Zoo Authority is headed by Minister of State for Environment & Forests (Forests & Wildlife), Government of India.

- Functions
- Recognition and Evaluation of the Zoos
- Coordination in the planned conservation breeding programme for endangered species in Indian zoos
- Approval of the exchange proposals of animals between Indian zoos and between Indian and foreign zoos
- Preparing and maintaining the studbooks etc

Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS)



- BNHS is one of the largest non-governmental organisations in India engaged in conservation and biodiversity research.
- It was founded on 15 September 1883 and headquartered at Hornbill House, Mumbai.
- It supports many research efforts through grants and publishes the Journal of the Bombay Natural History Society.
- Department of Science and Technology has designated it as a 'Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation'.



- **Important Bird Areas (IBAs)**
- Declared under IBA programme of Birdlife International
- The Bombay Natural History Society and Birdlife International identified 554 IBAs in India.
- Aim:
- To identify, monitor and protect a global network of IBAs for conservation of the world's birds and associated biodiversity.
- Serve as conservation areas for protection of birds at the global, regional or sub-regional level.

International Measures



- Criteria according for declaring Important Bird Areas by Birdlife International:
- hold significant numbers of one or more globally threatened bird species,
- be one of a set of sites that together hold a suite of restricted-range species or biome restricted species and
- have exceptionally large numbers of migratory or congregatory birds.

International Measures



- Birdlife International:
- It is a global partnership of conservation organisations that strives to conserve birds, their habitats and global biodiversity, working with people towards sustainability in the use of natural resources
- It is world's largest conservation partnerships for conservation of birds and their habitats.
- It publishes a quarterly magazine, World Birdwatch, which contains recent news and authoritative articles about birds, their habitats, and their conservation around the world.

Previous Year Questions



The most important strategy for the conservation of biodiversity together with traditional human life is the establishment of

- a) Biosphere reserves
- b) Botanical gardens
- c) National parks
- d) Wildlife sanctuaries

Solution

(A)

Biosphere Reserves are special entities (sites) for how human beings and nature can co-exist while respecting each other's needs.

Biosphere Reserve is an area of active cooperation between the management and the local people, wherein activities like settlements, cropping, forestry, recreation, and other economic activities are in harmony with the conservation goals.

Previous Year Questions



Consider the following statements :

1. Animal Welfare Board of India is established under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986
2. National Tiger Conservation Authority is a statutory body
3. National Ganga River Basin Authority is chaired by the Prime Minister

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 2 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(B) 2 and 3 only

Animal Welfare Board of India (AWBI) is a statutory body under the Union Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change (MoEF).

It was established in 1962 under Section 4 of The Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960.

National Tiger Conservation Authority is a statutory body.

The National Ganga River Basin Authority is chaired by the Prime Minister.

Previous Year Questions



With reference to 'Eco-Sensitive Zones', which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Eco-Sensitive Zones are the areas that are declared under the Wildlife (Protection) Act, of 1972.
2. The purpose of the declaration of Eco-Sensitive Zones is to prohibit all kinds of human activities, in those zones except agriculture.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Solution

(D)

The Eco-sensitive zones are ecologically Fragile Areas within 10 km of protected areas to act as buffer zone.

Such zones are notified under section 3 of the Environment Protection Act of 1986 by the Ministry of Environment and Forest. Hence, statement 1 is incorrect.

Agriculture, Horticulture practices by local communities, organic farming, rainwater harvesting, scientific research, tourism, etc. are permitted in the Eco-sensitive zones. Hence, statement 2 is incorrect.

Previous Year Questions



BioCarbon Fund Initiative for Sustainable Forest Landscapes' is managed by the

- (a) Asian Development Bank
- (b) International Monetary Fund
- (c) United Nations Environment Programme
- (d) World Bank

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(d)

The BioCarbon Fund Initiative for Sustainable Forest Landscapes collaborates with forest countries around the world to reduce emissions from the land sector through smarter land use planning, policies, and practices

Previous Year Questions



Which of the following best describes/describe the aim of 'Green India Mission' of the Government of India?

1. Incorporating environmental benefits and costs into the Union and State Budgets thereby implementing the 'green accounting'
2. Launching the second green revolution to enhance agricultural output so as to ensure food security to one and all in the future
3. Restoring and enhancing forest cover and responding to climate change by a combination of adaptation and mitigation measures

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(c) 3 only

The Mission proposes a holistic view of greening and focuses not on carbon sequestration targets alone, but also, on multiple ecosystem services, especially, biodiversity, water, biomass etc., along with provisioning services like fuel, fodder, timber and non-timber forest produce.

Previous Year Questions



In India, if a species of tortoise is declared protected under Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, what does it imply?

- (a) It enjoys the same level of protection as tiger
- (b) It no longer exists in the wild, a few individuals are under captive protection; and now it is impossible to prevent its extinction
- (c) It is endemic to a particular region of India
- (d) Both (b) and (c) stated above are correct in this context

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(A)

The Wild Life (Protection) Act of 1972: Schedule 1 includes Endangered species.

In India, if a species of tortoise is declared protected under Schedule I of the Act, it enjoys the same level of protection as the tiger

Previous Year Questions



According to the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, which of the following animals cannot be hunted by any person except under some provisions provided by law?

1. Gharial
2. Indian wild ass
3. Wild Buffalo

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(D)

They all are placed under Schedule 1 of WPA

Previous Year Questions



Consider the following statements:

1. The definition of "Critical Wildlife Habitat" is incorporated in the Forest Rights Act, of 2006.
2. For the first time in India, Baigas have been given Habitat Rights.
3. Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change officially decides and declares Habitat Rights for Primitive and Vulnerable Tribal Groups in any part of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(a) 1 and 2 only

The phrase ‘critical wildlife habitat’ is defined only in the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006. Hence, statement 1 is correct.

Previous Year Questions



‘Gadgil Committee Report’ and ‘Kasturirangan Committee Report’, sometimes seen in the news, are related to

- a) Constitutional reforms
- b) Ganga Action Plan
- c) Linking of rivers
- d) Protection of Western Ghats

Solution

(d)

The Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel (WGEEP), also known as the Gadgil Commission after its chairman Madhav Gadgil, was an environmental research commission appointed by the Ministry of Environment and Forests of India.

The Kasturirangan committee report has sought to balance the two concerns of development and environment protection, by watering down the environmental regulation regime proposed by the Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel's Gadgil report in 2012.

Previous Year Questions



How is the National Green Tribunal (NGT) different from the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)?

1. The NGT has been established by an Act whereas the CPCB has been created by an executive order of the government
2. The NGT provides environmental justice and helps reduce the burden of litigation in the higher courts whereas the CPCB promotes cleanliness of streams and wells, and aims to improve the quality of air in the country

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(B)

The National Green Tribunal has been established under the National Green Tribunal Act 2010 for effective and expeditious disposal of cases relating to environmental protection and conservation of forests and other natural resources.

While The Central Pollution Control Board of India is a statutory organisation under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change. It was established in 1974 under the Water Act, 1974. The CPCB is also entrusted with the powers and functions under the Air Act, 1981.

Previous Year Questions



Why is a plant called *Prosopis juliflora* often mentioned in news?

- a) Its extract is widely used in cosmetics.
- b) It tends to reduce the biodiversity in the area in which it grows.
- c) Its extract is used in the synthesis of pesticides.
- d) None of the above

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(b)

It is an invasive specie.

Invasive Species are those that have spread outside of their natural habitat and threaten biodiversity in their new area. Eg. Prosopis Juliflora.

Previous Year Questions



Consider the following States:

1. Chhattisgarh
2. Madhya Pradesh
3. Maharashtra
4. Odisha

With reference to the States mentioned above, in terms of the percentage of forest cover to the total area of the State, which one of the following is the correct ascending order?

- a) 2-3-1-4
- b) 2-3-4-1
- c) 3-2-4-1
- d) 3-2-1-4

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(c)

The percentage of forested area in 2017 by the state as published by the Forest Survey of India in ascending order is:

Maharashtra (16.47%), Madhya Pradesh (25.11%), Odisha (32.98%), Chhattisgarh (41.09%).

Previous Year Questions



The Environment Protection Act, 1986 empowers the Government of India to

1. State the requirement of public participation in the process of environmental protection, and the procedure and manner in which it is sought
2. Lay down the standards for emission or discharge of environmental pollutants from various sources

Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(B)

Section 3-2(iv) Central Government may lay down standards for emission or discharge of environmental pollutants from various sources whatsoever.

Previous Year Questions



Under Ramsar convention

1. It is mandatory on the part of the Government on India in protect and conserve all the wetlands in the territory of India
2. The Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2010 were framed by the Government of India based on the recommendations of Ramsar convention.
3. The Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2010 also encompass the drainage area or catchment regions of the wetlands as determined by the authority

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(C) 3 only

It is not mandatory for India to add all the sites in the list and conserve them

Previous Year Questions



Consider the following statements:

1. As per law, the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority exists at both National and State levels.
2. People's participation is mandatory in the compensatory afforestation programmes carried out under the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(A) 1 only

As per law, the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority exists at both National and State levels. Hence, statement 1 is correct.

It does not provide for mandatory people participation in the compensatory afforestation programmes carried out under the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016. Hence, statement 2 is incorrect

Previous Year Questions



With reference to the ‘New York Declaration on Forests’, which of the following statements are correct?

1. It was first endorsed at the United Nations Climate Summit in 2014
2. It endorses a global timeline to end the loss of forests
3. It is a legally binding international declaration
4. It is endorsed by governments, big companies and indigenous communities.
5. India was one of the signatories at its inception

Select the correct answer using the code given below

- (a) 1, 2 and 4
- (b) 1, 3 and 5
- (c) 3 and 4
- (d) 2 and 5

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(A)

Launched at the UN Secretary-General's Climate Summit in September 2014, the New York Declaration on Forests (NYDF) outlines ten ambitious global targets to protect and restore forests and end natural forest loss by 2030.

The New York Declaration on Forests is a voluntary and non-legally binding political declaration which grew out of dialogue among governments, companies and civil society.

India was not a signatory at its inception.

Previous Year Questions



If a particular plant species is placed under Schedule VI of The Wildlife Protection Act, 1972, what is the implication?

- (a) A license is required to cultivate that plant
- (b) Such a plant cannot be cultivated under any circumstances
- (c) It is a Genetically Modified crop plant
- (d) Such a plant is invasive and harmful to the ecosystem

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(A)

Wildlife Protection Act, 1972, had six schedules (before 2021 amendment).

No person is allowed to cultivate a specified plant mentioned in schedule 6, except with a license granted by the Chief Wild Life Warden.

Previous Year Questions



Statement 1:

The United Nations Capital Development Fund (UNCDF) and the Arbor Day Foundation have recently recognized Hyderabad as 2020 Tree City of the World

Statement 2:

Hyderabad was selected for recognition for a year following its commitment to grow and maintain the Urban forests.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement 1 and Statement 2 are correct and Statement 2 is the correct explanation for Statement 1
- (b) Both Statement 1 and Statement 2 are correct but Statement 2 is not the correct explanation for Statement 1.
- (c) Statement 1 is correct but Statement 2 is not correct.
- (d) Statement 1 is not correct but Statement 2 is correct.

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(D)

Hyderabad was recognised as Tree City of the World by Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) and the Arbor Day Foundation. So, Statement 1 is wrong. Statement 2 is correct.

Previous Year Questions



“If rainforests and tropical forests are the lungs of the Earth, then surely wetlands function as its kidneys.” Which one of the following functions of wetlands best reflects the above statement?

- (a) The water cycle in wetlands involves surface runoff, subsoil percolation and evaporation.
- (b) Algae form the nutrient base upon which fish, crustaceans, molluscs, birds, reptiles and mammals thrive.
- (c) Wetlands play a vital role in maintaining sedimentation balance and soil stabilization.
- (d) Aquatic plants absorb heavy metals and excess nutrients.

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(D)

Wetlands are vital for humans, for other ecosystems and for our climate, providing essential ecosystem services such as water regulation, including flood control and water purification.

Wetlands also absorb carbon dioxide so help slow global heating and reduce pollution, hence have often been referred to as the “Kidneys of the Earth”.

Previous Year Questions



The “Miyawaki method” is well known for the:

- (a) Promotion of commercial farming in arid and semi-arid areas
- (b) Development of gardens genetically modified flora using
- (c) Creation of mini forests in urban areas
- (d) Harvesting wind energy on coastal areas and on sea surfaces

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(C)

The Miyawaki forestation method is a unique way to create an urban forest and is pioneered by Japanese botanist Akira Miyawaki who in the 1970s, began to plant young native plant species — trees, shrubs, and grasses — in tight groves to restore degraded lands.

Saplings planted close together grow rapidly as they compete for light. By planting a native tree assortment, replicating the vegetation layers found in a mature forest, Miyawaki was engineering (and fast-forwarding) the stages of ecological succession by which a degraded plot turns naturally into a forest.

Previous Year Questions



Which one of the following has been constituted under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 ?

- (a) Central Water Commission
- (b) Central Ground Water Board
- (c) Central Ground Water Authority
- (d) National Water Development Agency

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(C)

Central Ground Water Authority has been constituted under Section 3 (3) of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 to regulate and control development and management of ground water resources in the country.

It issues necessary regulatory directions for the purpose. It exercises powers under the Act for the appointment of officers

Previous Year Questions



2014

1. With reference to Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS), consider the following statements:
2. It is an autonomous organization under the Ministry of Environment and Forests.
3. It strives to conserve nature through action-based research, education and public awareness.
4. It organizes and conducts nature trails and camps for the general public.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Previous Year Questions



Solution

(C)

It is one of the largest non-governmental organisations

The Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS), a pan-India wildlife research organization, has been promoting the cause of nature conservation since 1883.

BNHS Mission: Conservation of nature, primarily biological diversity through action based on research, education and public awareness

BNHS Vision: Premier independent scientific organization with a broad-based constituency, excelling in the conservation of threatened species and habitats.

It organizes and conducts nature trails and camps for the general public.

Previous Year Questions



2016

With reference to an organization known as 'Birdlife International' which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is a Global Partnership of Conservation Organizations.
2. The concept of 'biodiversity hotspots' originated from this organization.
3. It identifies the sites known/referred to as 'Important Bird and Biodiversity Areas'.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Previous Year Questions



Solution

C

BirdLife international is a global partnership of conservation organisations that strives to conserve birds their habitats and global biodiversity.

It is working with people towards sustainability in the use of natural resources.

It is the Worlds largest partnership of conservation organisations with over 120 partner organizations.

An Important Bird and Biodiversity Area IBA is an area recognized as being globally important habitat for the conservation of bird populations. The program was developed and sites are identified by BirdLife International.

Previous Year Questions



At the national level, which ministry is the modal agency to ensure effective implementation of the scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006?

- [A] Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- [B] Ministry of Panchayati Raj
- [C] Ministry of Rural Development
- [D] Ministry of Tribal Affairs

Previous Year Questions



Solution

D

The Union Ministry of Tribal Affairs (MoTA) is the nodal agency for the implementation of the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition Of Forest Rights) Act, 2006. The ministry deals with forest and livelihood objectives at the national level.

Previous Year Questions



Consider the following statements:

1. 36% of India's districts are classified as “overexploited” or “critical” by the Central Ground Water Authority (CGWA).
2. CGWA was formed under the Environment (Protection) Act.
3. India has the largest area under groundwater irrigation in the world.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 2 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Previous Year Questions



Solution

B

Central Ground Water Authority (CGWA) has been constituted under Section 3 (3) of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 to regulate and control development and management of ground water resources in the country. Hence, statement 2 is correct.

India's irrigation is mostly groundwater well based. At 39 million hectares (67% of its total irrigation), India has the world's largest groundwater well equipped irrigation system (China with 19 mha is second, USA with 17 mha is third). Hence, statement 3 is correct.

313 units (5%) are 'Critical', where the stage of ground water extraction is between 90-100 %. Hence, statement 1 is incorrect

Q.1

Q.) Consider the following statements:

1. As per recent amendment to the Indian Forest Act, 1927, forest dwellers have the right to fell the bamboos grown on forest areas.
2. As per the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006, bamboo is a minor forest produce.
3. The Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006 allows ownership of minor forest produce to forest dwellers.

Which of the statement given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3 |

Answer: B

- The Indian Forest (Amendment) Bill 2018 permits felling and transit of bamboo grown in non-forest areas. However, bamboo grown on forest lands would continue to be classified as a tree and would be guided by the existing legal restrictions. Hence,
- Statement 1 is Not Correct. • The Forest Rights Act (FRA) of 2006 recognises bamboo as an Minor Forest Produce
- It vests the "right of ownership, access to collect, use and dispose of minor forest produce" with Scheduled Tribes and traditional forest dwellers. Hence Statement 2 is Correct. In 2006, the Forest Rights Act (FRA) for the first time defined minor forest produce as including bamboo and tendu and many other things.
- It also gave tribals and other traditional forest dwellers the "right of
- ownership, access to collect, use and dispose of minor forest produce, which has been traditionally collected within or outside village boundaries."
- Hence Statement 3 is Correct

Q.2



Q.) Under the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006, who shall be the authority to initiate the process for determining the nature and extent of individual or community forest rights or both?

- A. State Forest Department
- B. District Collector/Deputy Commissioner
- C. Tahsildar/Block Development Officer/Mandal Revenue Officer
- D. Gram Sabha

Answer: D

- According to Chapter IV of the FRA, 2006, the Gram Sabha is the authority to initiate the process for determining the nature and extent of individual or community forest rights or both.

GRAM SABHA:

- 1. Gram Sabha is the authority for Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional
- Forest Dwellers within the local limits of its jurisdiction. 2. It receives claims, consolidates and verifies them, prepares a map delineating the area of each recommended claim in such manner as may be prescribed for the exercise of such rights.
- 3. It then passes a resolution to the effect, and thereafter forwards a copy of the same to the Sub-Divisional Level Committee.
- STATE LEVEL MONITORING COMMITTEE: